



C#

Level 1

MDI Container



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Definition

 MDI (Multiple Document Interface) Container

 Allows a main form to contain and manage multiple child forms.

 In this example, Form1 is the MDI Parent and Form2 is the MDI Child.

Explanation

Create a Child Form

 ``Form2 frm = new Form2();`` creates a new Form2 instance.

Set the MDI Parent

 ``frm.MdiParent = this;`` sets Form1 as the parent of Form2.

Show the Child Form

 ``frm.Show();`` displays Form2 inside the MDI Parent.

Procedure

1. Create an instance of Form2.
2. Set Form1 as its MDI Parent.
3. Show Form2.
4. Form2 appears inside Form1.

💡 Example

```
private void button1_Click(object sender, EventArgs e)
{
    Form2 frm = new Form2();
    frm.MdiParent = this;
    frm.Show();
}
```

➡ Result

Form2 opens inside Form1 as an MDI Child.

Note

- ◆ The main form must have `IsMdiContainer` enabled.
- ◆ `this` refers to the current `Form1` instance.



Comparison

- ▨ MDI Parent
 - ✓ Main/container form.
 - ✓ Contains and manages child forms.

- ▤ MDI Child
 - ✓ Form displayed inside the MDI Parent.
 - ✓ Example: Form2.

✦✦ Summary

- ✓ MDI Container allows multiple child forms inside one main form.
- ✓ `MdiParent` defines the parent-child relationship.
- ✓ `Show()` displays the child form.

Thank you 😊